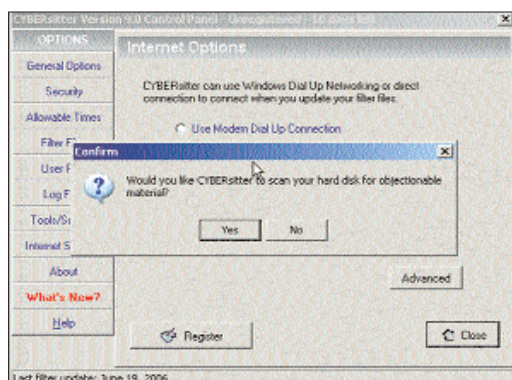


CYBERSitter 9.0

This is a very popular software today, and at 2.36 MB, it's the smallest download of them all. At \$39.95 (Rs 1,800), it's not the cheapest though!

Installation and configuration were a snap, as we've come to expect from all these software—all Windows software actually! A nifty feature was that when installing, CYBERSitter offers to search your hard drive for "objectionable material." I don't have any, so I didn't scan, but it's nice to see something a little different amongst such software. I have also read that this "scan" finds spyware and porn diallers as well, though I had none on my fresh install of Windows XP Pro.



CYBERSitter can scan your hard drive for pornography

While installing, I left the default values for all the various checkboxes I saw, but noticed that you can choose to filter e-mail content as well! It cannot filter chat programs, but can block them outright—good if you have pre-teens around the house.

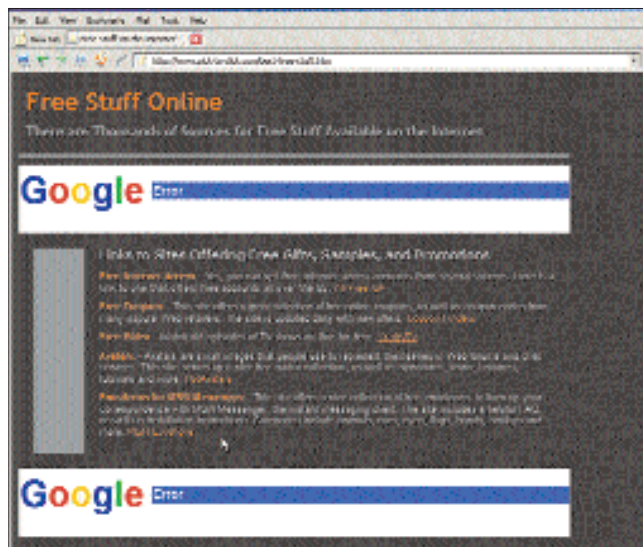
In this 10-day trial version, password protection is disabled, and you'll have to buy the software to get that very important feature. However, since this is not brain surgery, I don't foresee any problems with password protection in the full version!

While installing, you can select the type of content you want blocked, and then "Update Filters"—which basically means you update the program's database of blocked sites. The software lets you disable access to the Registry Editor, Task Manager, and either the entire Control Panel or just the Network/Internet icons in the Control Panel.

CYBERSitter offers the time management feature that many of the others did as well, so you can control not just how but also when your kids use the PC. In order to make sure no one can change the system time and fool the application, it also lets you disable the Windows Time application and the command prompt.

The software offers scheduled e-mail reporting for parents who want to keep an eye on what's happening at home, and also has logging that you can come home and check.

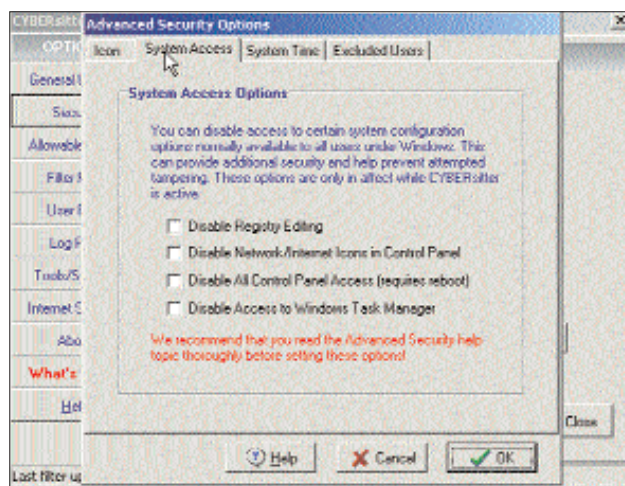
The software blocked everything very well, and was the only software in this test to not allow us to search Google Images with Safe



Not only does CYBERSitter force strict safe searches, it also forwards you to a page that contains clean, free stuff online

Search off. It forced Strict Safe Search in popular search engines, and ignored all my attempts to change this—and this, with all browsers! Although it did not filter images for content—it read the associated tags and forced safe searches in image search engines—I gave it a 4/5 for image filtering.

CYBERSitter blocks silently, just bringing up a "page not found" or some such error message, making the surfer believe that the page doesn't work, rather than knowing that he/she is being blocked. I think this is a good thing, as it might stop the natural curiosity that kids have. It's easier for kids to accept "the site doesn't work" than "Mommy/daddy doesn't want me to see this site!"



CYBERSitter can disable the Task Manager and the Control Panel, making it a secure program that also blocks well—a true winner here!

This was by far the most secure software I tested, and it would require a really gifted and geeky teen hacker to bypass its security. Overall a very good software, which blocks exceptionally well. It even blocked our "innocuous sites," and made life miserable for me while I was trying to fool it. If you're willing to spend the money, this is a really good option!